Questions for Rebecca

Please answer whichever questions you can. We can discuss the rest in person.
Return your written answers to admin@sarahblanch.com, or bring them to the interview.

Q1 · Priorities, scope and support

What are your two main business priorities for the next year, what have previous changes in scale taught you, and what would make you adjust the plan?

Q2 · Priorities, scope and support

Which Bottrell businesses and services are currently active, which are paused or inactive, and which would fall within my remit?

Questions for Rebecca

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Return your written answers to admin@sarahblanch.com, or bring them to the interview.

Q3 · Priorities, scope and support

Who would I report to, what authority and resources would I have, and which decisions would remain with owners or qualified specialists?

Q4 · Priorities, scope and support

How would we agree priorities, protected project time and decision boundaries early so I can manage competing demands independently and reduce the day-to-day management and checking you need to do?

Questions for Rebecca

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Q5 · Systems, clients and results

What would success look like at 30, 60 and 90 days, what baseline and evidence would we use, and how would the 90-day review guide my responsibilities, authority and the next quarter's priorities?

Q6 · Systems, clients and results

Which systems are the authoritative records for the business, where is work repeated, and what results have existing automation or AI projects demonstrated?

Questions for Rebecca

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Q7 · Systems, clients and results

Which clients and services best fit your growth plan, and where do profitability, staff capacity and service quality support taking on more work?

Q8 · Systems, clients and results

How is an enquiry tracked through to engagement and handover, where are improvements needed, and which marketing activities have demonstrated that they bring suitable clients?

Questions for Rebecca

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Q9 · Hiring, onboarding and staff readiness

How many people currently work in each team, how many hires are approved or proposed by role and level, and how will recruitment and start dates be staggered around training, supervision and review capacity?

Q10 · Hiring, onboarding and staff readiness

What changes are planned for job-ad content, listing channels and candidate assessment, and how will you measure whether these attract people with the capabilities and reliability you need?

Questions for Rebecca

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Q11 · Hiring, onboarding and staff readiness

Who owns the current staff onboarding process, when was it last reviewed and updated, and what happened with the most recent starter from accepting the offer to being signed off for independent work?

Q12 · Hiring, onboarding and staff readiness

Is there a shared business induction with separate pathways for qualified accountants, trainees, administration, marketing, IT, other specialists, temporary staff and contractors? What must be ready before day one, including equipment, access, guidance, training and assigned support?

Questions for Rebecca

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Q13 · Hiring, onboarding and staff readiness

How many established staff reliably work independently, who has demonstrated the ability to train others, and how do you determine the limits of their knowledge? What preparation, protected time and specialist support would they need to train staff across different parts of the business?

Q14 · Hiring, onboarding and staff readiness

How do you check that staff understand the active businesses and services, give accurate and consistent on-brand answers, know when to involve a specialist, and receive updated guidance when something changes?

Questions for Rebecca

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Q15 · Hiring, onboarding and staff readiness

What guidance, practical trials and role-specific simulations are used for new and existing staff, including difficult-client situations? How do assessment, feedback, retesting and sign-off establish readiness, and who makes that decision?

Q16 · Hiring, onboarding and staff readiness

Would it fit your structure for me to own the onboarding system, materials and improvement reporting, with qualified service leads and designated trainers responsible for technical teaching and daily supervision?

Questions for Rebecca

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Q17 · Client boundaries, formal concerns and working terms

What client behaviour crosses an agreed boundary, what can staff do immediately, and what remedies or concessions can they approve without asking an owner? How are staff supported and matters escalated, including when a valuable client is involved?

Q18 · Client boundaries, formal concerns and working terms

What are the actual systems for staff to raise a different view or concern, for addressing formal staff performance concerns, and for handling formal client complaints? Who owns each process, how is it recorded and escalated, and how are decisions, outcomes and follow-up communicated?

Questions for Rebecca

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Q19 · Client boundaries, formal concerns and working terms

What working hours, locations and base salary are budgeted for this remit, and can we record the agreed hybrid pattern, responsibilities and complete remuneration package in the contract?

Q20 · Client boundaries, formal concerns and working terms

What questions or concerns remain about my suitability for the role, including handling difficult clients? What would you like me to explain or demonstrate at our follow-up interview?